

Q.7a (20 marks): Factors responsible for decline in marriage and anthropological interpretations of live-in rela...

anything in this Arc

27. (a) Briefly describe the factors responsible for decline in marriage in the world and also give anthropological interpretations of live in relationships.
(20 marks)

The observation of decline in Marriage practices in the world is being studied as a part of Socio-Cultural anthropo-
-logy as previously scholars have claimed functional attributes of Marriage but they seem to be changing in recent context of live-in Relationships.

Factors Responsible

(I) Economic Factors

- ① Growing economic independence and decreasing inter-dependence.
- ② Growing Urbanisation leading to growth of associations to support live-in relationships.

(II) Cultural Factors.

- (1) Increasing Individualism due to weaker kinship bonds.
- (2) Feminist Movements attacking role of Wife and Motherhood.
- (3) Education leading to Occupational Mobility and Marriage being seen as a restriction to this.

These factors are collectively giving way to Live-In-Relationship which is a prolonged or permanent bond in which couples live together but don't commit to Marriage. Reasons for increase:

- (1) Growing desire to check compatibility before committing to Marriage.
- (2) Getting rid of family hassles.
- (3) Legal issues don't come in way if Marriage ends.

- ④ to support each other in terms of financial and living arrangements.
- ⑤ When marriage is not allowed like same-sex marriage and inter-religious marriage.

Anthropological Interpretation

Trial Marriages: in anthropology is defined as a practice where couples live together first and then commit to the bond of marriage. It is found in several simple societies.

↳ Example. Shahmawar Akhtar (2014) studied 'Dapa System' in Jaisi Tribals of Rajasthan. In this the females to a fair and select mates to elope with. Marriage is officiated if Bride Price is paid otherwise marriage ends.

- Also found in Nestlé's Intuits where marriage is officiated if offspring is born.

→ Hence, one can place live in Relationship as a contemporary aspect of Trial Marriages. However, such relationships need Social Sanction more than a Legal Sanction to be accepted in Society.

Live-in Relationship v/s Marriage. But

Still the kind of emotional security marriage provides is irreplaceable, so anthropologically one can see live-in as a pre-cursor of Marriage and not an outright replacement of Marriage.

Marks:

Comment:

Intro:

Body:

Conclusion:

Total:

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